

About the Authority Governance Standard (AGS)

Canonical Definition

Authority Governance Standard (AGS) defines the structural conditions under which authority remains identifiable, legitimate, attributable, bounded, traceable, governable, enforceable, and operationally valid throughout operational environments.

AGS governs authority.

The standard establishes the foundational conditions required to determine who possesses the legitimate right to decide, approve, authorize, direct, restrict, supervise, intervene, delegate, escalate, or govern actions within an operational system.

What This Standard Is

AGS is a parent standard of the Accountability Governance Architecture (AGA™).

It governs:

- authority identification
- authority legitimacy
- authority attribution
- authority scope
- authority continuity
- authority accountability

AGS establishes the authority layer of governance analysis.

The standard determines who possesses the legitimate right to act before governance evaluates responsibility, control, oversight, evidence, and accountability.

What This Standard Is Not

AGS is not:

- a responsibility standard
- a capability standard
- a control standard
- an oversight standard
- an evidence standard
- an accountability standard

AGS does not determine who was responsible.

AGS determines who possessed the legitimate right to act.

Why This Standard Exists

Modern operational environments contain increasingly complex authority structures.

Authority may originate from:

- organizational hierarchies
- governance systems
- regulations
- contracts
- supervisory structures
- delegated authority chains
- AI orchestration environments
- autonomous operational systems

As operational complexity increases, authority becomes increasingly difficult to identify, validate, and reconstruct.

Governance cannot reliably determine responsibility or accountability unless authority is first understood.

AGS exists to solve this problem.

Core Insight

Before governance can determine who was responsible, governance must first determine who possessed authority.

Operational Architecture Space

AGS defines the operational architecture space for:

- authority governance
- authority identification
- authority legitimacy
- authority attribution
- authority scope governance
- authority continuity
- authority accountability
- delegated authority governance
- distributed authority governance
- Human-AI authority governance
- agent authority governance

This space exists because authority determines who may legitimately act within a governance system.

General Use Case 1 — Multi-Layer Organizational Environment

Scenario

A large organization operates through executives, managers, supervisors, contractors, and external service providers.

Application

AGS governs identification and reconstruction of authority structures across the operational environment.

Result

Governance gains visibility into who possessed authority before responsibility and accountability analysis begins.

General Use Case 2 — Orchestrated Agent Environment

Scenario

An orchestration platform coordinates multiple AI agents, execution systems, external tools, and human supervisors.

Application

AGS governs identification and validation of authority relationships throughout the operational system.

Result

Governance gains visibility into who possessed the legitimate right to initiate, approve, restrict, delegate, or supervise actions.

Architectural Position

Within AGA™, AGS serves as the second foundational governance layer.

The architecture progresses:

Relationship → Authority → Responsibility → Capability → Control → Oversight → Evidence → Accountability → Consequence

AGS governs the authority layer of this sequence.

Closing Definition

Authority governance is not the governance of actions. Authority governance is the governance of the legitimate right to initiate,

approve, direct, restrict, supervise, delegate, or govern actions within an operational system.

Authority determines who may act. If authority cannot be identified, validated, bounded, or reconstructed, responsibility and accountability become unreliable.

Related Documents

→ [Authority Governance Standard - \(AGS\)](#).

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Canonical Source

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